

**UGED1111 Logic**

**Symbolic Language  
and  
Truth Table II**

# Logical Relations and Properties of Propositions

## Logical Properties of propositions

1. Tautologous
2. Self-contradictory
3. Contingent

## Logical relations of propositions:

1. Logically Equivalent
2. Contradictory
3. Consistent
4. Inconsistent

# Properties of Propositions

## Tautologous

- **Necessarily true**
- **it is true regardless of the truth values of its components**
- **True in every possible interpretation , not just in actual world**
- **E.g.  $P \vee \sim P$**

# Properties of Propositions

## Self-contradictory

- **Necessarily false**
- **it is false regardless of the truth values of its components**
- **false in every logical possibility , not just in actual world**
- **E.g.  $P \cdot \sim P$**

# Properties of Propositions

## Contingent

- Its truth value varies depending on the truth values of its components.
- True in some logical possibilities; false in some logical possibilities
- i.e. at least one line true and at least one line false
- E.g.  $P \cdot Q$

# Discussion 3

**What is the logical property of the following propositions?**

1.  $(P \vee Q) \equiv \sim Q$
2.  $(P \supset Q) \cdot (\sim Q \cdot P)$

# Answer 3.1

| P | Q | $(P \vee Q) \equiv \sim Q$ |
|---|---|----------------------------|
| T | T | F                          |
| T | F | T                          |
| F | T | F                          |
| F | F | F                          |

Contingent

# Answer 3.2

| P | Q | $(P \supset Q) \cdot (\sim Q \cdot P)$ |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|----------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| T | T | T                                      | T | T | F | F | T | F | T |
| T | F | T                                      | F | F | F | T | F | T | T |
| F | T | F                                      | T | T | F | F | T | F | F |
| F | F | F                                      | T | F | F | T | F | F | F |

Self-contradictory



# Relations of Propositions

## Logically Equivalent

For any wffs  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$ ,  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are logically equivalent just in case they have the same truth value in every logical possibility.

| P | Q | $\sim$ P | $\vee$ Q | / | P | $\supset$ Q |
|---|---|----------|----------|---|---|-------------|
| T | T | F        | T        |   | T | T           |
| T | F | F        | F        |   | T | F           |
| F | T | T        | T        |   | F | T           |
| F | F | T        | T        |   | F | T           |

# Relations of Propositions

## Contradictory

For any wffs  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$ ,  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are contradictory just in case  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  have different truth values in every logical possibility.

| P | Q | $\sim$ Q | $\cdot$ P | / P | $\supset$ Q |
|---|---|----------|-----------|-----|-------------|
| T | T | F        | F         | T   | T           |
| T | F | T        | T         | T   | F           |
| F | T | F        | F         | F   | T           |
| F | F | T        | F         | F   | T           |

# Relations of Propositions

## Consistent

For any wffs  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$ ,  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are consistent just in case there is at least one logical possibility that  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are both true.

| P | Q | $\sim$ Q | $\vee$ P | / P | $\supset$ Q |
|---|---|----------|----------|-----|-------------|
| T | T | F        | T        | T   | T           |
| T | F | T        | T        | T   | F           |
| F | T | F        | F        | F   | T           |
| F | F | T        | T        | F   | T           |

# Relations of Propositions

## Inconsistent

For any wffs  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$ ,  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are inconsistent just in case there is no logical possibility that  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are both true.

| P | Q | $\sim$ | Q | $\equiv$ | P | / | P | $\cdot$ | Q |
|---|---|--------|---|----------|---|---|---|---------|---|
| T | T | F      | T | F        | T | T | T | T       | T |
| T | F | T      | F | T        | T | T | F | F       | F |
| F | T | F      | T | T        | F | F | F | F       | T |
| F | F | T      | F | F        | F | F | F | F       | F |

# Discussion 4

**What is/are the logical relations of the following propositions?**

- 1.  $P \supset Q / \sim Q \cdot P$**
- 2.  $P \vee (Q \supset S) / S \vee (Q \supset P)$**

# Answer

| P | Q | (P $\supset$ Q) / ( $\sim$ Q $\cdot$ P) |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|-----------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| T | T | T                                       | T | T | F | T | F | T |
| T | F | T                                       | F | F | T | F | T | T |
| F | T | F                                       | T | T | F | T | F | F |
| F | F | F                                       | T | F | T | F | F | F |

**Contradictory and inconsistent**

**\*\*If two propositions are **Contradictory**, they must be **inconsistent**.**

# Answer

| P | Q | S | $P \vee (Q \supset S) / S \vee (Q \supset P)$ |
|---|---|---|-----------------------------------------------|
| T | T | T |                                               |
| T | T | F |                                               |
| T | F | T |                                               |
| T | F | F |                                               |
| F | T | T |                                               |
| F | T | F |                                               |
| F | F | T |                                               |
| F | F | F |                                               |

# Answer

| P | Q | S | P | $\vee$ | $(Q \supset S)$ | / | S | $\vee$ | $(Q \supset P)$ |
|---|---|---|---|--------|-----------------|---|---|--------|-----------------|
| T | T | T | T | T      | T               | T | T | T      | T               |
| T | T | F | T | T      | F               | F | F | T      | T               |
| T | F | T | T | T      | F               | T | T | T      | T               |
| T | F | F | T | T      | F               | F | F | T      | T               |
| F | T | T | F | T      | T               | T | T | T      | F               |
| F | T | F | F | F      | T               | F | F | F      | F               |
| F | F | T | F | T      | F               | T | T | T      | F               |
| F | F | F | F | T      | F               | T | F | T      | F               |

Logically Equivalent and consistent



# Validity

Checking the validity of an argument with truth table:

1. In a truth table for argument, we need to **list out all the possible truth values of premises and conclusion in the truth table.**
2. To clearly indicate premises and conclusion, we use “ / ” to separate the premises and “// ” to separate the last premise and the conclusion.
3. If you can find **any rows showing all true premises and false conclusion** , then the argument is invalid. (Indicate that row when you find it. )

# Discussion 4



Use a complete truth table to check whether the argument is valid.

1.  $P \supset Q / \sim P // Q$

# Answer

| P | Q | P $\supset$ Q | / | $\sim$ P | // | Q |
|---|---|---------------|---|----------|----|---|
| T | T | T             |   | F        |    | T |
| T | F | F             |   | F        |    | F |
| F | T | T             |   | T        |    | T |
| F | F | T             |   | T        |    | F |

Invalid

# Discussion 5

Use a complete truth table to check whether the argument is valid.

1.  $\sim T \supset S / \sim S \vee (\sim T \supset R) / \sim T // R$

# Answer

| R | S | T | $\sim$ | T | $\supset$ | S | / | $\sim$ | S | $\vee$ | ( $\sim$ | T | $\supset$ | R) | / | $\sim$ | T | // | R |
|---|---|---|--------|---|-----------|---|---|--------|---|--------|----------|---|-----------|----|---|--------|---|----|---|
| T | T | T | F      | T | T         | T |   | F      | T | T      | F        | T | T         | T  |   | F      | T |    | T |
| T | T | F | T      | F | T         | T |   | F      | T | T      | T        | F | T         | T  |   | T      | F |    | T |
| T | F | T | F      | T | T         | F |   | T      | F | T      | F        | T | T         | T  |   | F      | T |    | T |
| T | F | F | T      | F | F         | F |   | T      | F | T      | T        | F | T         | T  |   | T      | F |    | T |
| F | T | T | F      | T | T         | T |   | F      | T | T      | F        | T | T         | F  |   | F      | T |    | F |
| F | T | F | T      | F | T         | T |   | F      | T | F      | T        | F | F         | F  |   | T      | F |    | F |
| F | F | T | F      | T | T         | F |   | T      | F | T      | F        | T | T         | F  |   | F      | T |    | F |
| F | F | F | T      | F | F         | F |   | T      | F | T      | T        | F | F         | F  |   | T      | F |    | F |

Valid

# Case

$$(\mathbf{N} \cdot \mathbf{P} \equiv (\mathbf{Q} \vee \mathbf{R})) \supset (\sim \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{M}) / (\mathbf{N} \cdot \mathbf{P}) / \mathbf{Q} // (\sim \mathbf{S} \cdot \mathbf{M})$$

Simple proposition as component: 6

We have to list  $2^6$  (i.e. 64 ) rows!

Indirect truth table saves our time!

# Indirect Truth Table

Indirect truth tables provide a faster way for checking validity of arguments.

◆ The idea is to check whether the argument is possible to have all true premises and a false conclusion by making assumptions.

◆ If it is possible for the argument to have all true premises and a false conclusion, then the argument is **invalid**. Otherwise, **valid**.

# Indirect Truth Table

We need to first **assume the conclusion is false and the premises are true**( which means it is invalid).

Then we have to see if there is any **contradiction** in the computation.

➤ If there is a contradiction, then the assumption is false , i.e. the argument is **valid**.

➤ If there is **no** contradiction, then there is a case that the conclusion is false and the premises are true, i.e. the argument is **invalid**.



# Example

## Whether the following argument is valid?

$$\sim(P \vee R)/Q \equiv \sim P//Q \cdot \sim R$$

[illegible]

# Case 1 : $\sim(P \vee R)/Q \equiv \sim P//Q \cdot \sim R$

- If there is a contradiction, then the assumption is false , i.e. the argument is **valid**.
- If there is **no** contradiction, then there is a case that the conclusion is false and the premises are true, i.e. the argument is **invalid**.
  - In the indirect truth table of this argument ,there is a contradiction.
  - Indicate the contradiction by circling it.
  - It is **valid**!!!!

| $\sim$ | (P | $\vee$ | R) | / | Q | $\equiv$ | $\sim$ | P | // | Q | $\cdot$ | $\sim$ | R |
|--------|----|--------|----|---|---|----------|--------|---|----|---|---------|--------|---|
| T      | F  | F      | F  |   | F | T        | F      | T |    | F | F       | T      | F |
| ①      | ③  | ②      | ③  |   | ⑦ | ①        | ⑧      | ⑨ |    | ⑥ | ①       | ⑤      | ④ |

# Indirect Truth Table

| $(P \equiv Q) \supset S$ | $/$ | $\sim S$ | $\cdot$ | $P$ | $//$ | $P \vee Q$ |
|--------------------------|-----|----------|---------|-----|------|------------|
| F                        | T   | F        | T       | T   | F    | F          |

Similar techniques you may  
have used before

SUDOKU!!!!!!

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | 8 |   |   | 6 | 1 |   |   | 2 |
|   |   | 2 | 3 |   |   |   |   | 1 |
| 1 | 9 |   |   |   | 7 | 6 | 4 | 5 |
|   | 1 | 6 |   | 2 |   | 5 |   | 9 |
| 3 |   | 7 | 1 |   | 8 | 4 |   | 6 |
| 9 |   | 4 |   | 7 |   | 3 | 1 |   |
| 2 | 3 | 1 | 8 |   |   |   | 5 | 7 |
| 7 |   |   |   |   | 2 | 1 |   |   |
| 5 |   |   | 7 | 1 |   |   | 6 | 3 |

# Indirect Truth Table

□ Sometimes we need to make further assumption if the truth value of certain letters are not fixed by previous steps.

| P | $\supset$ | Q | / | Q | $\supset$ | P | // | P | $\equiv$ | Q |
|---|-----------|---|---|---|-----------|---|----|---|----------|---|
| T | T         | F |   | F | T         | T |    | T | F        | F |
| 3 | 1         | 4 |   | 4 | 1         | 3 |    | 2 | 1        | 2 |
| F | T         | T |   | T | T         | F |    | F | F        | T |
| 3 | 1         | 4 |   | 4 | 1         | 3 |    | 2 | 1        | 2 |

□ If no contradiction is found, then the argument is invalid, you can stop further computation.

□ If a contradiction has been found, you **CANNOT** stop the computation. **You need to exhaust every logical possibility.**

# Reference

- Copi, I., Cohen, C., & McMahon, K. (2011). *Introduction to Logic (14th ed. / Irving M. Copi, Carl Cohen, Kenneth McMahon ed.)*. Upper Saddle River, NJ: Pearson Education.
- Hurley, P. (2015). *A Concise Introduction to Logic (12th ed.)*. Australia ; Stamford, Ct.: Cengage Learning.